
Topic 8: Health psychology

Topic overview

Students must show understanding that health psychology is about understanding health from a biological, cognitive and social basis and that health psychology is about promoting good health.

Individual differences and developmental psychology must be considered when learning about peer influence or labelling as explanations for drug misuse, and biological and learning explanations for drug misuse.

Subject content	What students need to learn:
8.1 Content	8.1.1 Issues around drug taking, including addiction, tolerance, physical and psychological dependency, withdrawal.
	Explanations of drug addiction 8.1.2 One biological explanation each for alcohol, heroin and nicotine addiction, including mode of action. 8.1.3 One learning explanation each for alcohol, heroin and nicotine addiction. Explanations may apply to more than one drug.
	Treatments for drug addiction 8.1.4 Two treatments each for alcohol, heroin and nicotine addiction, including aversion therapy. Treatments may apply to more than one drug.
	8.1.5 One anti-drug campaign and the psychological strategies behind it.
	8.1.6 Individual differences Biological and social factors in drug misuse can include effects dependent on differences in the individual, such as personality.
	8.1.7 Developmental psychology Social interactions during development can lead to drug misuse, including learning.